Q+A

The Gold Standard

After winning gold at the 2026 Asian Games, boxing star **Lovlina Borgohain** reflects on her journey and the rise of Indian boxing

Q. An Asian Games gold would have been one of your targets. How does it feel to have it finally checked off the bucket list?

I really enjoyed myself while playing this Asiad. It was on my mind to change the colour of the medal from silver to gold. Now I have to do the same for the Olympic medal.

Q. Both the Commonwealth and Asian Games have a formidable field of boxers. Do you feel India is a powerhouse in women's boxing?

Yes, most definitely. I'd say both men's and women's are doing great. In Aichi-Nagoya, we finished No. 1 in the boxing medal table. Indian boxers now have a competitive mindset; we have great facilities, good training partners, good coaches and international exposure too. When we go to play now, other nations take note as we have accomplished boxers in each category.

Q. You have been part of two back-to-back Olympics. It's hard to dethrone you from the 75kg category. What does it take to be on top of your game for so long?

I didn't even realise 15 years have passed since I started boxing. The journey hasn't been easy, with a fair share of losses along the way. You have to be mentally strong. I feel I have the willpower and a never-give-up attitude even when I am down.

Q. You and Mirabai Chanu are sporting icons who are always expected to return with a medal. Isn't it a huge responsibility to shoulder?

There must be something about us, which is why we are seen as medal contenders. It's also why we never take it easy. Earlier, it was hard for people from the North-east to even imagine they could make it in sports. But now the younger generation is inspired and aware of the Olympics and Asian Games. Parents feel their kids can give sports a chance.

—with Suhani Singh

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